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PG 3

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IITM Concludes Six-Day Data Analytics Workshop, Five Students Selected for IIM Bangalore Competition

IITM Bureau

The Department of Management Studies, Institute of Information Technology & Management (IITM), successfully concluded a six-day Certification Programme and Hands-on Workshop on "Data Analytics using Power BI & Tableau" for BBA students from June 22 to June 27, 2026. The programme was organized in collaboration with MakeIntern and E-Cell, IIM Bangalore, with the objective of equipping students with industry-relevant analytical skills and practical knowledge in the rapidly growing field of data analytics. The intensive workshop offered participants a comprehensive learning experience through interactive sessions,

practical demonstrations, and real-world business case studies. Students received hands-on training in Data Analytics, Business Intelligence, Power BI, Tableau, Data Visualization, Dashboard Development, and Data-Driven Decision Making. The sessions focused on bridging the gap between classroom learning and industry expectations by enabling students to work with live datasets and create interactive dashboards for business analysis. The workshop was led by Mr. Shiva, Senior Data Consultant at AllianceTek, USA, who served as the chief resource person throughout the programme. Drawing from his extensive industry experience, he guided participants

through various analytical tools, visualization techniques, and business intelligence practices while emphasizing the importance of data-driven strategies in modern organizations. The concluding day of the workshop featured an engaging capstone project presentation, where students showcased the analytical dashboards and business solutions they had developed during the training. Their projects were evaluated by an expert panel headed by Mr. Shiva, who assessed the participants based on innovation, analytical thinking, presentation skills, and practical application of the concepts learned during the workshop. Based on their outstanding performances, five students were



shortlisted to represent IITM, D-29, at the prestigious Business Plan Competition to be held at IIM Bangalore. The selected students are Paridhi Panwar, Vaani Dutta, Aastha, Chehek Wadhwa, and Vineet Kushwaha. Their selection reflects their exceptional analytical abilities, creativity, and dedication demonstrated throughout the programme. The Department of Management Studies expressed heartfelt

gratitude to MakeIntern, E-Cell, IIM Bangalore, resource person Mr. Shiva, faculty members, participants, and the organizing committee for their unwavering support and contributions in making the programme a remarkable success. The successful completion of the workshop reaffirms IITM's commitment to providing students with industry-oriented education and experiential learning opportunities.

IITM NCC Cell Marks World Environment Day 2026 with Plantation Drive and Awareness Activities

IITM Bureau

The NCC Cell of the Institute of Information Technology & Management (IITM), Janakpuri Information Campus, celebrated World Environment Day 2026 on Friday (June 5 2026) by organizing a plantation drive and a series of environmental awareness activities, reaffirming its commitment to sustainability, environmental conservation, and social responsibility. The event witnessed enthusiastic participation from NCC cadets, faculty members, and volunteers, who came together to promote the message of protecting nature and creating a greener future. As part of the celebration, cadets planted saplings across the campus, symbolizing their commitment to preserving the environment and enhancing the green cover. The plantation drive aimed to encourage students to recognize the importance of trees in maintaining ecological balance, improving air quality, and

combating the adverse effects of climate change. The initiative also highlighted the role of young citizens in building a sustainable and environmentally conscious society. Alongside the plantation drive, the NCC Cell organized awareness activities focusing on environmental protection, waste reduction, biodiversity conservation, and sustainable living practices. Cadets actively participated in discussions and awareness campaigns, emphasizing the importance of adopting eco-friendly habits in daily life. They encouraged fellow students to reduce plastic usage, conserve water, plant more trees, and contribute towards maintaining a clean and healthy environment. The programme reflected the core values of the National Cadet Corps, including discipline, leadership, responsibility, and community service. Through their active involvement, the cadets demonstrated that environmental conservation is not merely a one-day observance



but a continuous collective responsibility requiring consistent efforts from every individual. Addressing the participants, faculty members appreciated the enthusiasm and dedication shown by the cadets and encouraged them to become ambassadors of environmental awareness within their communities. They emphasized that small actions taken by individuals can collectively create a significant positive impact on the environment. The celebration concluded with a collective pledge by participants to protect natural resources, promote sustainable practices, and contribute actively towards environmental conservation. Reinforcing the message of the day, the programme echoed the inspiring thought, "Nature is not

a place to visit. It is home." Through initiatives like these, IITM continues to nurture socially responsible and environmentally conscious citizens while encouraging students to play an active role in creating a cleaner, greener, and healthier future for generations to come. The celebration concluded with a collective pledge by participants to protect natural resources, promote sustainable practices, and contribute actively towards environmental conservation. Through initiatives like these, IITM continues to nurture socially responsible and environmentally conscious citizens while encouraging students to play an active role in creating a cleaner, greener, and healthier future for generations to come.

IITM School of Mass Communication Students Attend News18 India's Amrit Ratna 2026 Event

IITM Bureau

Students of the IITM School of Mass Communication on 17 June, 2026, had the privilege of attending News18 India's prestigious Amrit Ratna 2026 event in New Delhi, gaining valuable exposure to one of the country's leading media platforms and its celebration of excellence across diverse fields. News18 India hosted the fourth edition of its flagship event, Amrit Ratna 2026, bringing together policymakers, industry leaders, artists, sportspersons, scientists, and distinguished achievers to honour individuals whose exceptional contributions have significantly shaped India's growth and development. The event recognised personalities whose work reflects the vision of "Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas, Sabka Vishwas, Sabka Prayas" and supports the nation's journey towards becoming a Viksit Bharat by 2047. According to a News18 India press re-

lease, the ceremony witnessed the presence of senior political leaders, eminent jury members, award recipients, and special guests, making it one of the network's most prominent annual events. This year's Amrit Ratna awards honoured several distinguished personalities, including former Indian football captain Bhaichung Bhutia, Indian Air Force Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla, singer Sonu Nigam, actor Rakesh Bedi, scientist Dr. Shubha V. Iyengar, veteran actress Zeenat Aman, renowned instrumentalists Pt. Vishwa Mohan Bhatt and Pt. Salil Vishwa Mohan Bhatt, actor Alia Bhatt, and Gurdas Maan for their achievements and lasting contributions across sports, science, entertainment, music, and public life. For the students of IITM School of Mass Communication, the visit proved to be an enriching experiential learning opportunity beyond the classroom. Witnessing the recognition of excellence by a leading national me-



dia network provided them with valuable insights into the role of journalism in highlighting inspiring stories, celebrating public service, and promoting positive social change. The programme also offered firsthand exposure to the planning, coordination, and execution of a high-profile media event. The event inspired students to appreciate the values of leadership, perseverance, innovation, and social responsibility. Listening to the experiences and achievements of eminent personalities encouraged them to strive for excellence in their own academic and professional pursuits while reinforcing the importance of ethical journalism and meaningful storytelling in contemporary media. The visit is im-

portant industry exposure that complements classroom learning by bridging the gap between theoretical knowledge and professional practice. Such interactions strengthen students' understanding of the media ecosystem and prepare them for the dynamic world of journalism and communication. The IITM School of Mass Communication continues to provide students with opportunities to engage with leading media organizations and industry events, ensuring they receive practical exposure alongside academic learning. Participation in News18 India's Amrit Ratna 2026 stands as another milestone in the institute's commitment to nurturing media professionals.

Amit Shah Launches FCRA 2.0 Portal and e-OCI Card to Strengthen India's Digital Governance Framework

IITM Bureau

Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation Amit Shah on Monday (June 29 2026) launched the FCRA 2.0 Portal and the Electronic Overseas Citizen of India (e-OCI) Card, aimed at strengthening digital governance, simplifying regulatory compliance and improving citizen services. The initiatives were launched in the presence of the Union Home Secretary, Foreign Secretary, Director of the Intelligence Bureau and other senior officials. The FCRA 2.0 Portal has been developed to digitise and streamline all major processes under the Foreign Con-

tribution (Regulation) Act (FCRA), including registration, renewal, filing of annual returns and other regulatory services. According to the Ministry of Home Affairs, the upgraded platform is designed to reduce paperwork, accelerate processing of applications and strengthen real-time monitoring of foreign contributions. Hosted on the National Government Cloud (MeghRaj), the portal features Aadhaar-based authentication, e-Sign facilities, OCR-based document analysis, integrated dashboards and API-based integration with key government databases, including PAN, Aadhaar, OCI, NGO Darnan and the Insti-



tute of Chartered Accountants of India's Unique Document Identification Number (UDIN) system. The ministry said around 14,500 organisations currently hold active FCRA registrations, while 15,000–20,000 applications and nearly 17,000 annual returns are processed annually. The new platform also incorporates provisions of the Foreign Contribution

(Regulation) Amendment Rules, 2026 and has been designed to support future features such as an AI-powered chatbot, mobile access and dedicated dashboards for banks. Addressing the event, Amit Shah said the portal reflects the government's efforts to leverage technology to improve governance, reduce procedural delays and strengthen oversight of foreign

contributions. He said digitisation would eliminate the need for physical submission of documents while improving transparency and compliance monitoring. The Home Minister also launched the e-OCI Card, a fully digital platform that enables Overseas Citizen of India applicants to complete the entire application process online, including submission of applications, uploading of documents and downloading of digitally generated OCI cards after approval. Existing OCI cardholders will also be able to obtain digital OCI cards in most cases without submitting fresh applications or undergoing physical verification.

Indian Railways Approves ₹200 Crore Optical Fibre Network to Strengthen Digital Communication and Railway Safety

IITM Bureau

Indian Railways has approved a ₹200 crore project for laying a 48-fibre Optical Fibre Cable (OFC) network across nearly 1,700 route kilometres of the South Eastern Railway (SER) zone on 30 June. The initiative is expected to strengthen the digital communication backbone of the railway network and improve the safety and efficiency of train operations. According to the Ministry of Railways, the project will provide 48-fibre OFC connectivity over 1,696.2 route kilometres spanning the Adra, Chakradharpur, Kharagpur and Ranchi divisions of South



Eastern Railway. The upgraded communication system will facilitate faster and more reliable transmission of operational data, enabling better coordination among railway stations, control offices and field units. The sanctioned project includes the laying of optical fibre cables over 545.4 route kilometres in the Adra Division, 392.3 route kilometres in the Chakradharnur Divi-

sion, 339.9 route kilometres in the Kharagpur Division and 418.6 route kilometres in the Ranchi Division. Railway officials stated that the new fibre optic network will significantly enhance the capacity and reliability of communication systems that support train operations. The advanced infrastructure is expected to play a crucial role in the deployment of modern railway technologies.

including digital signalling, real-time monitoring systems and data-driven operational management. The ministry further noted that the project would improve operational efficiency and provide a strong foundation for future expansion of railway services across the South Eastern Railway network. The high-capacity communication system will also help in strengthening safety mechanisms and ensuring seamless coordination during routine operations and emergency situations. The approval of this project forms part of Indian Railways' broader strategy to modernise its critical infrastructure through advanced digital technologies.

Over 1.31 Crore Citizens Join 'Nasha Mukht Bharat Saptah' 2026; Centre Boosts Anti-Drug Campaign

IITM Bureau

More than 1.31 crore citizens participated in the nationwide 'Nasha Mukta Bharat Saptah' 2026 on 26 June, as the Union Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment intensified its campaign against substance abuse through awareness drives, community engagement and strategic partnerships. The week-long campaign, observed from 17 June to 26 June to mark the International Day Against Drug Abuse and Illicit Trafficking, concluded with a National Awareness Programme at Dev

Sanskriti Vishwavidyalaya (DSVV) in Haridwar, Uttarakhand. Union Minister for Social Justice and Empowerment Dr. Virendra Kumar led the concluding programme, which was attended by Dr. Chinmay Pandya, Pro Vice-Chancellor of DSVV, along with government officials, representatives from states and Union Territories, volunteers, educational institutions and civil society organisations. A major highlight of the event was a 'Nasha Mukta Rally' led by the Union Minister, which witnessed the participation of nearly

4,000 citizens, reflecting widespread public support for the national campaign against drug abuse. During the programme, Kumar administered the Pledge Against Drug Abuse as well as the Ageing with Dignity Pledge, reiterating the government's commitment to building a drug-free and inclusive society. Throughout the 10-day campaign, awareness and community mobilisation activities were organised across the country. These included Nasha Mukti Mitra registration drives, seminars, webinars, training programmes for children and youth,

street plays, skits, rallies, yoga sessions, signature campaigns, essay and painting competitions, slogan-writing contests, e-pledges, and several other public outreach initiatives aimed at spreading awareness about the dangers of substance abuse. The event also witnessed the signing of two Memorandums of Understanding (MoUs) between the Department of Social Justice and Empowerment and the All World Gayatri Pariwar under the Nasha Mukht Bharat Abhiyaan (NMBA) and the Atal Vayo Abhyuday Yojana (AVYAY).

India Condemns Pakistan's Air Strikes on Afghanistan, Reaffirms Support for Sovereignty

IITM Bureau

India on 29 June, 2026 strongly condemned Pakistan's reported air strikes on Afghan territory, describing them as a blatant act of aggression that has led to civilian casualties, including the deaths of women and children. The MEA termed the attacks a serious violation of Afghanistan's sovereignty and warned that such actions could further destabilise an already fragile region. In an official statement, the MEA said the air strikes represented an unacceptable assault on Afghanistan's territorial integrity and posed a direct threat to regional peace and security. India also

criticised what it described as Pakistan's recurring pattern of reckless behaviour, alleging that Islamabad has repeatedly attempted to externalise its internal challenges by engaging in violence beyond its borders. "Such acts not only undermine the sovereignty of neighbouring countries but also endanger regional stability and the prospects for peace," the ministry said. Expressing deep concern over the humanitarian consequences of the strikes, India conveyed its condolences to the families of those who lost their lives and wished a speedy recovery to the injured. The government particularly highlighted

the tragic impact on civilians, including women and children, who were among the victims of the attacks. India reiterated its long-standing support for Afghanistan's sovereignty, territorial integrity and independence. The MEA affirmed that New Delhi remains committed to the peace, stability and welfare of the Afghan people and continues to support efforts aimed at ensuring a secure and prosperous Afghanistan. The statement comes amid growing tensions in the region following reports of the Pakistani air strikes. India has once again underlined the importance of respecting international norms.

Centre, Rajasthan and Haryana Sign Agreement to Implement Yamuna Water Project

IITM Bureau

The governments of Rajasthan and Haryana on Monday (June 29, 2026) signed an agreement for the construction and implementation of the Yamuna Water Project, marking the resolution of a long-pending inter-state water issue. The agreement was signed in the presence of Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation Amit Shah, Rajasthan Chief Minister Bhajan Lal Sharma, Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini and Union Jal Shakti Minister C.R. Patil.

underground pipeline system connected to the Western Yamuna Canal, enabling the state to utilise the water allocated under the 1994 Memorandum of Understanding on the sharing of utilisable surface waters of the Upper Yamuna Basin. Under the agreement, around 580 million cubic metres (MCM) of water will be supplied from the Yamuna Canal to Rajasthan between July and October through three underground pipelines, each measuring more than 3.6 metres in diameter. The project is expected to improve drinking water supply in Sikar, Churu and Jhunjhunu districts of Rajasthan, while also benefiting the Bhiwani and Fateh-



habad regions of Haryana. According to the Ministry of Jal Shakti, the agreement lays down a comprehensive framework covering water allocation, financial responsibilities, cost-sharing, water release protocols, infrastructure operation and maintenance, monitoring mechanisms, transparency measures and dispute resolution. Addressing the event, Amit Shah described the agreement as a significant step in resolving a water-related issue that had remained pending for

nearly three decades. He said the agreement reflects the spirit of cooperative federalism and coordinated efforts between the Centre and the two states. The project also seeks to utilise rainwater that previously went unused by storing it in large ponds, helping improve groundwater recharge in the region. The Union Home Minister also said the framework prepared for the project is designed to ensure long-term implementation and minimise future disputes.

PM Modi meets Mauritian counterpart Ramgoolam, reviews Enhanced Strategic Partnership

IITM Bureau

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on 28 June, met his Mauritian counterpart, Navinchandra Ramgoolam, in the Seychelles capital and discussed all aspects of the bilateral relationship. This was Prime Minister Modi's fourth meeting with Prime Minister Ramgoolam since the latter assumed office in November 2024. Meeting on the sidelines of Seychelles' Golden Jubilee National Day celebrations, the two leaders reviewed the full spectrum of the India-Mauritius Enhanced Stra-

tegitic Partnership, including development cooperation, maritime security, trade, capacity building, and people-to-people ties, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said. The two leaders also discussed ongoing bilateral cooperation and reviewed the progress made in the implementation of the Special Economic Package extended by India. “Prime Minister Modi underscored the importance India attaches to the development and progress of Mauritius, noting that the ongoing bilateral projects will contribute to Mauritius’ healthcare, con-



nectivity, sustainable development, and blue economy,” the MEA said in a post on X. “The two Prime Ministers agreed on the significance of the India-Mauritius Enhanced Strategic Partnership under India’s Vision Mutual and Holistic Advancement for Security and Growth Across Regions (MAHASAGAR) and Neighbourhood First policy, as well as their shared commitment to the Global South.”

The leaders reaffirmed their commitment to continue working closely for mutual growth and to promote peace, stability, and prosperity in the Indian Ocean Region. In April, External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar visited Mauritius for the inauguration of the country's first dedicated renal transplant unit and said that healthcare cooperation between the two nations would continue to expand.

Twin Earthquakes Push Venezuela's Healthcare System Into Crisis, WHO Warns Amid Mounting Humanitarian Emergency

IITM Bureau

Venezuela's healthcare system is facing severe pressure in the aftermath of two powerful earthquakes that struck the country last week, leaving thousands of people dead, injured, and displaced. The World Health Organization (WHO) on Tuesday (June 30 2026) warned that hospitals and medical facilities are struggling to cope with the growing humanitarian crisis, as damaged infrastructure, overcrowded hospitals, and shortages of healthcare workers continue to hamper relief efforts. According to the WHO, more than 1,700 people have lost their lives, while over 5,000 others have been injured after the

back-to-back earthquakes measuring 7.2 and 7.5 on the Richter scale. The twin quakes caused widespread destruction, flattening or severely damaging hundreds of buildings, including hospitals, homes, schools, and public infrastructure across affected regions. Speaking at a press briefing in Geneva, WHO spokesperson Christian Lindmeier said that an initial assessment of 21 healthcare facilities revealed extensive damage. At least three health centres have been critically damaged, while six others have suffered partial damage and are functioning only at a limited capacity. Although the remaining hospitals continue to operate, they are under enormous strain due to the overwhelming number of patients requiring emergency treatment. Lindmeier said preliminary findings indicate that healthcare services have become increasingly chaotic. Hospitals are experiencing severe overcrowding, disrupted patient flow, and growing surgical backlogs as doctors and medical staff work around the clock to treat those injured in the disaster. Emergency wards are reportedly operating beyond capacity, making it difficult to provide timely medical care. The situation has been further complicated by a shortage of healthcare professionals. Several



maternity care specialists in the coastal city of La Guaira remain missing following the earthquakes, creating a critical gap in obstetric and maternal healthcare services. This has raised concerns about the safety of pregnant women and newborns in the affected areas. The WHO has also warned of an increased risk of disease outbreaks among the

thousands of displaced people living in temporary shelters. Poor sanitation, overcrowding, and relatively low vaccination coverage could contribute to the spread of mosquito-borne diseases such as yellow fever and dengue. International humanitarian agencies are continuing to provide emergency medical supplies, temporary healthcare services & disease surveillance.

Oman Opens Temporary Strait Of Hormuz Shipping Corridor

IITM Bureau

On June 24 2026, Oman announced the opening of a temporary maritime shipping corridor through the strategically important Strait of Hormuz, a move aimed at restoring commercial shipping and easing a prolonged maritime crisis that has disrupted global trade and left thousands of seafarers stranded in the Gulf region. The initiative comes after months of heightened regional tensions that affected the safe movement of merchant vessels through one of the world's busiest and most critical shipping routes.



According to the Omani government, the temporary corridor has been established in close coordination with the United Nations' International Maritime Organization (IMO). The arrangement is designed to facilitate the safe passage of commercial ships while ensuring the security of crews and cargo transiting the waterway. The Strait of Hormuz serves as a vital gateway connecting the Persian Gulf with the Arabian Sea and is a key route for the transportation of crude oil, liquefied natural gas, and other essential commodities to global markets. The IMO has reported that more than 11,000 seafarers remain stranded in the Gulf region due to the disruption of maritime operations.

Under a phased transit and evacuation plan, these seafarers are expected to receive assistance as shipping activities gradually resume. The organization has welcomed Oman's initiative, describing it as an important step toward restoring confidence in international maritime navigation. Oman's Maritime Security Centre has designated temporary shipping lanes to the north and south of the existing traffic separation scheme, which authorities currently consider unsafe for regular navigation because of security concerns. Ships intending to use the temporary corridor will be required to fol-

low a controlled transit process and coordinate their movements in advance with both the IMO and Omani maritime authorities. Officials say these measures are intended to minimize risks while maintaining orderly vessel traffic through the narrow waterway. The Omani government has also reaffirmed its commitment to international maritime law and the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea. Meanwhile, Oman and Iran have agreed to establish a joint working group to discuss the long-term management of navigation and maritime services in the Strait of Hormuz.

Zimbabwe passes bill to extend presidential term, end direct elections

IITM Bureau

Members of the Zimbabwean Parliament (MPs) have passed a bill on June 22 2026 that would extend the presidential term from five to seven years, delaying the country's 2028 election and allowing sitting President Emmerson Mnangagwa to remain in power until 2030. Text of the bill also shifts the power to elect a president from a direct popular vote to selection by the MPs, a move that takes places the political choice in the hands of individuals feared to be detached from the wants and needs of ordinary citizens. The controversial legislation, Constitution



of Zimbabwe Amendment (No. 3) bill, or CAB3, passed through the lower house of Parliament with 216 votes in favor, clearing the two-thirds supermajority (187 votes) required to amend the constitution. Next, the bill is to go before the 80-member Senate, the smaller upper house of Parliament, before being signed into law by the president. Lawmakers expect the bill to pass through

the Senate smoothly, as it is controlled by Mnangagwa's political party, the Zimbabwe African National Union-Patriotic Front (ZANU-PF). Once a liberation movement and now the governing political party, ZANU-PF maintains that its chief principles are to foster national peace and security through democratic values. Dubbed "the Crocodile," President Mnangagwa came to power in 2017 after a

military-backed coup ousting then-president Robert Mugabe, who held power for 37 years following Zimbabwe's independence from the United Kingdom in 1980. Mugabe's presidency, also under the ZANU-PF party, was marked by political unrest and repression as well as violent and disputed elections. Like those under Mugabe, Mnangagwa's elections have been met with controversy, further entrenching the cycle of political unrest and repression. His presidency, which was set to end in its second and final term in 2028, has seen instability and accusations of human rights violations. The passing of CAB3 follows a trend of pow-

er extensions by many nations in Africa, some of which have extended presidential term limits by decades, effectively making the incumbent leader permanent. The proposed constitutional amendment has sparked widespread debate over the future of democracy, constitutional governance, and electoral accountability in Zimbabwe. While supporters argue that the changes will promote political stability and policy continuity, critics contend that delaying elections and transferring the power to elect the president from citizens to Parliament could weaken democratic institutions and reduce public participation in governance.

Pakistan Forces Kill 29 Militants in Border Operation ; Kabul Says Dozens Dead, Injured

IITM Bureau

Pakistan's security forces launched coordinated ground and air operations along the Pakistan-Afghanistan border on 28 June, killing at least 29 militants, according to Pakistani authorities. However, the Afghan Taliban claimed that the air strikes also resulted in dozens of civilian casualties, including women and children, further escalating tensions between the two neighbouring countries. Pakistan's Information Minister Attaullah Tarar said the military operation targeted militant hideouts linked to cross-border terrorism. In a post on X early Monday, Tarar stated that four mili-

itants associated with Jamaat-ul-Ahrar, a faction of the Pakistani Taliban were killed during ground operations conducted near the border. He added that Pakistan's air force simultaneously carried out precision strikes on three suspected militant targets located in Afghanistan's eastern provinces of Paktia, Paktika, and Kunar. According to the minister, the air strikes killed 25 militants and destroyed large quantities of weapons, ammunition, and other military equipment allegedly being used by militant groups to launch attacks inside Pakistan. Mujahid describing the strikes said, "The

attacks resulted in the deaths and injuries of dozens of civilians, including women and children. We strongly condemn this cowardly act of aggression and consider it a crime and an act of brutality." Afghan authorities have not yet released an official casualty figure or independently verified the number of civilian deaths. Pakistan said the military action was undertaken in response to a series of recent terrorist incidents carried out by militant groups operating near the border. The Afghan Taliban has consistently denied these allegations, maintaining that it does not allow its territory to be used against any country.

Magnitude 6.9 quake strikes Japan's northeast

IITM Bureau

A powerful earthquake measuring 6.9 on the Richter scale struck off Japan's northeastern coast on 25 June, prompting emergency response measures by the government. However, authorities confirmed that no tsunami warning was issued, no casualties were immediately reported, and no abnormalities were detected at nearby nuclear facilities. According to the Japan Meteorological Agency (JMA), the earthquake's epicenter was located off the coast of Iwate Prefecture in the Tohoku region at a depth of approximately 50 kilometres (30 miles). While the quake

was strong enough to be felt across a wide area, officials stated that no significant tsunami damage was expected. The agency noted that only minor fluctuations in sea levels could occur along parts of the coastline. The tremor registered a maximum intensity of 6-plus on Japan's seven-level seismic intensity scale in Aomori Prefecture. At this intensity, people find it extremely difficult to remain standing, and movement often requires crawling due to the severity of the shaking. Residents in several areas reported strong vibrations, though there were no immediate reports of major structural damage. Following the earthquake, the Japanese government established an emergency task force to collect information and coordinate any necessary disaster response efforts. Chief Cabinet Secretary Minoru Kihara said authorities were closely monitoring the situation and stood ready to provide relief assistance if required. Safety inspections were immediately conducted at nuclear facilities across the affected region. Tohoku Electric Power reported that no irregularities were found at its Onagawa Nuclear Power Plant or the idled Higashidori Nuclear Power Plant.

G7 Leaders Unite in France to Address Global Security, Economy, and AI Governance

IITM Bureau

The 52nd G7 Summit was held from 15 to 17 June 2026 in Evian-les-Bains, France, under the presidency of French President Emmanuel Macron. Leaders of the Group of Seven (G7), A major agenda item was the ongoing conflict in Ukraine, with G7 leaders reaffirming their commitment to Ukraine's sovereignty and announcing continued political, financial, and military support. The leaders also discussed the evolving situation in the Middle East, welcoming diplomatic efforts aimed at reducing tensions and supporting regional stability. Other

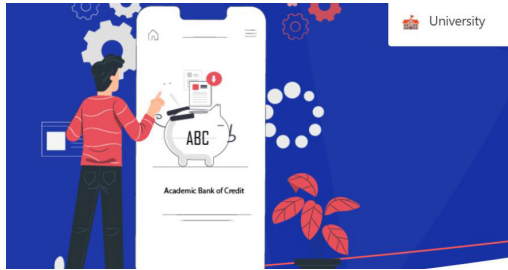
key outcomes included commitments to strengthen international cooperation against organized crime and illicit trafficking, improve digital safety for children, advance artificial intelligence governance, and enhance global economic resilience. Canada, France, Germany, Italy, Japan, the United Kingdom, and the United States—along with the European Union and invited partner countries, including India, met to discuss pressing global challenges. The summit focused on restoring balanced economic growth, addressing geopolitical conflicts, strengthening global governance, and promoting resilient supply chains for critical minerals. France also emphasized the importance of stronger partnerships with emerging economies and the Global South to address shared challenges such as climate change, energy security, and sustainable development. The summit concluded with a series of joint declarations reaffirming the G7's commitment to multilateral cooperation, democratic values, and international peace and security. The outcomes of the summit highlighted the G7's determination to strengthen international cooperation in addressing complex global challenges.

Academic Bank of Credits and APAAR Strengthen India's Digital Education Ecosystem

Ashmin Kaur

The Academic Bank of Credits (ABC) and the Automated Permanent Academic Account Registry (APAAR) are emerging as key pillars of India's digital education ecosystem, enabling students to securely store, transfer and redeem academic credits while supporting flexible learning pathways envisioned under the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020. Developed by the Ministry of Education and regulated by the University Grants Commission (UGC), the Academic Bank of Credits is a digital platform that allows students to maintain a lifelong academic record. The platform enables credits earned from recognised higher education institutions to be accumulated, transferred and redeemed, allowing learners to continue their education without losing academic progress. The system is integrated with the APAAR

(Automated Permanent Academic Account Registry), a unique 12-digit student identification number introduced under the 'One Nation, One Student ID' initiative. Linked to DigiLocker, APAAR consolidates a learner's academic records across school education, higher education, skill development and other learning programmes into a single digital identity. According to the Ministry of Education, more than 26.30 crore verified APAAR IDs have been generated across the country as of June 2026. Under the ABC framework, students receive an ABC or APAAR ID linked to their Aadhaar and DigiLocker accounts, while recognised higher education institutions upload academic credits directly to the platform. The National Academic Depository (NAD) serves as the backbone of the system by securely storing academic awards and educational records. The UGC has directed all higher education institutions to upload students' academic credit data to the ABC portal by June 30, 2026. As per official data, 2,963 institutions have registered on the platform, while more than 110.65 crore educational records have been uploaded. The platform also enables seamless credit transfer between institutions, reducing documentation requirements through consent-based digital verification. It supports the Multiple Entry and Exit (MEE) framework, allowing students to earn certificates, diplomas and degrees at different stages of their academic journey. According to the ministry, 153 universities currently offer multiple entry options, benefiting more than 31,000 undergraduate and 5,500 postgraduate students. ABC has also been integrated with SWAYAM, allowing students to earn up to 40 per cent of their ac-



academic credits through online courses. The platform is aligned with the National Credit Framework (NCRF), which integrates academic, vocational and experiential learning. As of 2026, 170 universities have adopted the framework. To ensure secure handling of academic records, the platform uses encrypted systems and Aadhaar-linked authentication through DigiLocker. Common Service Centres (CSCs) have also been integrated into the system to facilitate APAAR registration in rural and remote areas, improving access to digital education services. According to the Ministry of Education, the Academic Bank of Credits forms an important part of India's Digital Public Infrastructure for education. Looking ahead, the ministry has proposed the adoption of Bharat Praman Chain, a sovereign blockchain platform developed by the Digital India Corporation, to further strengthen the security, authenticity and verification of digital academic credentials while ensuring compliance with the Digital Personal Data Protection Act. The Academic Bank of Credits and APAAR together represent a transformative shift towards a learner-centric, technology-driven education system that promotes flexibility, transparency and lifelong learning. ABC and APAAR are poised to play a crucial role in creating an efficient, future-ready and globally competitive academic ecosystem.

Climate Change & Wildfires: Environmental, Human and Economic Costs

Dr. Rajnesh Kumar Pandey



The recent wildfire in Tamil Nadu's Nilgiris region has once again drawn attention to the growing threat of wildfires in an era of climate change. Fuelled by soaring temperatures, prolonged dry spells and strong winds, the blaze scorched more than 5,000 acres of forest in April 2026 before being brought under control after nearly two weeks of intensive firefighting operations. Scientists warn that 2026 is witnessing one of the most severe wildfire seasons in recent years, with devastating fires reported across Asia, Africa, Australia and South America as extreme weather conditions become more frequent and intense. Wildfires are no longer viewed as isolated natural disasters but as a global environmental emergency closely linked to climate change. Rising temperatures, declining rainfall and prolonged drought have created ideal conditions for forests and grasslands to ignite and spread rapidly. Human activities such as deforestation, careless disposal of flammable materials and unsustainable land-use practices have further increased the risk of catastrophic fires.

The environmental consequences of wildfires are enormous. Forests, grasslands and wildlife habitats are destroyed within hours, causing irreversible damage to biodiversity. Thousands of animals are killed, injured or displaced, while fragile ecosystems take years, sometimes decades, to recover. Burning vegetation releases vast quantities of carbon dioxide, carbon monoxide and harmful particulate matter into the atmosphere, worsening air pollution and accelerating global warming. The destruction of forests also reduces the Earth's ability to absorb carbon dioxide, further intensifying climate change. In addition, extreme heat damages soil fertility by destroying essential nutrients and microorganisms, while ash and toxic debris contaminate rivers, lakes and groundwater sources. Wildfires also pose a serious threat to public health. Dense smoke exposes millions of people to hazardous air pollutants, leading to respiratory illnesses, asthma attacks, lung infections and cardiovascular complications, particularly among children, senior citizens and individuals with pre-existing medical conditions.

Beyond physical illness, wildfires leave lasting psychological impacts as families lose homes, livelihoods and loved ones, often resulting in trauma, anxiety and depression. Firefighters and emergency personnel also face significant health risks while battling blazes under extreme weather conditions. The economic losses caused by wildfires are equally severe. Homes, roads, power infrastructure, agricultural land and public facilities are often destroyed, requiring massive investments in reconstruction and rehabilitation. Farmers suffer heavy losses as crops, livestock and grazing lands are damaged, while tourism-dependent regions experience declining visitor numbers due to environmental destruction and safety concerns. Governments must also spend substantial resources on firefighting operations, emergency relief and disaster recovery, placing additional pressure on already strained public finances. Experts believe that without stronger climate action, improved forest management and better disaster preparedness, the frequency and intensity of wildfires will continue to rise.

Photo of the Month



Photo Credit: Ms. Dipti Tiwari

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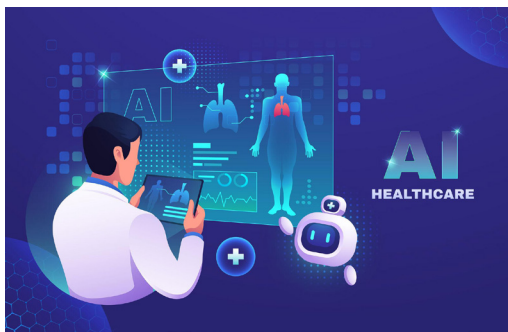
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AI Reshapes Modern Healthcare with Innovation and Ethical Responsibility

IITM Bureau

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is rapidly transforming healthcare, making medical services faster, more accurate and more accessible. Once considered a futuristic technology, AI has now become an integral part of modern medicine, helping doctors diagnose diseases, perform complex surgeries, develop new medicines and improve patient care. While these advancements offer enormous benefits, they also raise important concerns about ethics, patient privacy and accountability. As AI becomes increasingly integrated into healthcare, it is essential to ensure that technology complements, rather than replaces, human expertise and compassion. AI refers to computer systems capable of performing tasks that normally require human intelligence, such as learning from data, recognising patterns and making decisions. In healthcare, AI analyses vast amounts of medical information in a short time, enabling doctors to make quick

er and more informed decisions. Rather than replacing healthcare professionals, AI serves as a powerful tool that enhances medical practice. One of AI's greatest contributions is early disease detection. AI-powered systems can analyse X-rays, CT scans, MRI images and laboratory reports to identify diseases such as cancer, heart disorders and neurological conditions at an early stage. Early diagnosis significantly improves treatment outcomes and saves lives. AI also supports personalised medicine by recommending treatment plans based on a patient's medical history, lifestyle, age and genetic profile, resulting in more effective care with fewer side effects. AI is also revolutionising surgery through robotic-assisted procedures. These advanced systems help surgeons perform complex operations with greater precision, leading to smaller incisions, reduced pain and faster recovery. In pharmaceutical research, AI has accelerated drug discovery by analysing millions of scientific studies and chemical compounds within days, dramatically reducing the time required to develop new medicines. This capability proved especially valuable during the COVID-19 pandemic. Beyond hospitals, AI-powered chatbots, virtual assistants and wearable devices are improving healthcare accessibility. Smartwatches and fitness bands can monitor heart rate, blood oxygen levels, sleep patterns and detect abnormal heart rhythms, enabling early medical intervention. Technology companies and research institutions are collaborating with healthcare providers to develop AI tools for cancer detection, Alzheimer's diagnosis and patient record management, making healthcare more efficient and preventive. Despite these benefits, AI presents several challenges. Protecting patient privacy remains a major concern, as AI systems rely on large volumes of sensitive medical data. Data breaches or misuse could compromise



patient confidentiality. AI systems may also produce biased or inaccurate results if trained on incomplete or unrepresentative datasets, potentially affecting the quality of treatment. Another critical issue is accountability when AI-generated recommendations lead to incorrect diagnoses or medical decisions. Artificial Intelligence is reshaping healthcare by improving diagnosis, treatment, surgery and medical research. However, its success depends on responsible implementation that balances innovation with ethics, privacy and patient safety. The future of healthcare lies in a partnership between human intelligence and artificial intelligence, creating a system that is not only smarter and more efficient but also compassionate, trustworthy and centred

on the well-being of every patient. Looking ahead, the responsible integration of Artificial Intelligence will depend on strong ethical frameworks, robust data protection and continuous human oversight. While AI has the potential to make healthcare more efficient, accessible and personalised, it should always support—not replace—the expertise, empathy and clinical judgement of healthcare professionals. By striking the right balance between innovation and patient-centred care, AI can help build a smarter, safer and more inclusive healthcare system for the future. Its true success will ultimately be measured not only by technological advancement but also by its ability to improve patient outcomes and enhance the quality of life for all.

US Embassy in India Secures \$20.5 Billion Investment, Tops Global Diplomatic Missions

IITM Bureau

US Ambassador to India Sergio Gor said on June 30, 2026 that the US Embassy in New Delhi has attracted new investments worth \$20.5 billion in the US this year. With this achievement, the US mission in India has reached the first position among all US embassies worldwide in terms of increasing investment. Speaking at the US-India Strategic Partnership Forum (USISPF) Leadership Summit, Sergio Gor said that this achievement is a big sign of growing trust in India and strengthening economic ties between the two countries. "There's a kind of competition among all our US embassies. This year, the

US Embassy in New Delhi brought \$20.5 billion in new investment to the US, far ahead of all other missions. This is a matter of great pride and satisfaction for us," he said. Sergio Gor stated that India has emerged as a trusted investment destination. This is why American companies are showing greater confidence than ever before in working with India. He explained that when American companies ask questions like, "Is it safe to invest in India?" "Will their intellectual property (IP) be protected here?" "Will laws change suddenly?" "Is the tax system stable and reliable?" They are proud to respond that the United States trusts and works closely with



India. The ambassador said he has witnessed many positive changes during his six-month tenure in India. The US Embassy is no longer limited to formal meetings, but is focused on achieving concrete economic results. "As President Donald Trump says, we work for results," he said. "I haven't come to India just to attend receptions. My goal is to further strengthen this vital partnership, which is vital to both

countries." Sergio Gor stated that the US Embassy is always open to investors and businesses. He urged companies to contact the embassy directly if they encounter any obstacles to their investment or business projects due to regulations or government procedures. He said, "Our embassy is always open to you. Come see us and let us know how we can help. Files often get stuck in government processes in

both countries. If we can help move a case forward by getting it to the right person, we will. You will always find our embassy supportive and positive." The US ambassador stated that President Donald Trump's administration considers economic diplomacy a key component of its foreign policy. He added that Trump himself plays an active role in helping American companies expand their business abroad. He said, "No deal is too small. If an investment creates jobs in the US, the President is willing to make phone calls in support of that company. This is a highly proactive approach, unlike any other political party's government."

India and UK exploring new opportunities to deepen economic and trade cooperation: Piyush Goyal

IITM Bureau

Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Friday (June 26, 2026) said India and the UK are committed to building an ecosystem that fosters innovation, investment and inclusive growth for both countries. After talks with Business and Trade Secretary Peter Kyle, Goyal said, "This conversation reflected the warmth, trust and forward-thinking spirit that continues to be the hallmark of our bilateral partnership." Piyush Goyal posted on the social media platform 'X', "With the India-UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA) and the Double Contribution Convention (DCC)



coming into force from July 15, 2026, we are committed to creating an ecosystem that fosters innovation, investment and broad-based growth for both countries." Earlier, he addressed a business event attended by a large number of business leaders and investors from both India and the UK. "I spoke at the talks about how the India-UK CETA will create huge opportunities for growth and prosperity in both

countries," Goyal said. He urged them to take full advantage of this important agreement to deepen cooperation, enhance trade and investment, and promote innovation in various sectors. Earlier, Union Minister Goyal had said that the India-UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement will prove to be a 'force multiplier' for the global economy by strengthening cooperation between the two countries in trade, in-

vestment, technology and strategic sectors. Speaking at the India Global Forum's UK-India Week 2026 in London, Goyal said the partnership between India and the United Kingdom has grown significantly over the last few years and has now evolved into a very strategic relationship covering multiple sectors. He said that bilateral relations between the two countries have now expanded beyond traditional trade ties to include cooperation in technology, investment, defence and essential minerals. The growing engagement between the two countries reflects the increasing depth and breadth of the India-UK partnership.

RBI issues Q&A on frequently asked questions related to Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank)

IITM Bureau

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has issued clarifications on June 24, regarding several key questions related to the recently announced FCNR(B) (Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) Deposit Scheme) and the special swap facility. The central bank clarified that Indian banks will be able to provide loans to NRI customers against their FCNR(B) deposits. Banks will also be permitted to impose liens on the deposits for such loans. The RBI has also clarified that under the special

foreign currency swap facility, it will bear hedging costs only on the principal amount of FCNR(B) deposits. Interest earned on the deposits will not be included in the scope of this facility. This will help banks accurately price the deposits raised under this scheme. On June 5, 2026, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra announced several measures to increase foreign exchange inflows and strengthen the country's external financial position. Under this initiative, a special swap facility was introduced for

FCNR(B) deposits, external commercial borrowing (ECB), and foreign currency borrowing. Under the scheme, the RBI will bear the entire cost of hedging on new FCNR(B) deposits of three to five years tenor raised by banks till September 30, 2026, with an aim to encourage banks to raise more foreign currency deposits. According to an FAQ issued by the RBI, Indian banks and their overseas branches can provide loans to NRI customers holding FCNR(B) deposits. Banks can also issue standby letters of cred-



it (SBLCs) in favor of foreign lenders. The central bank clarified that banks can grant loans abroad to FCNR(B) account holders and can also impose a lien on the deposit as security. The RBI stated that only the principal amount of the deposit will be covered under the special swap facility. The

interest earned on the deposit will not be included in this facility, meaning banks will have to make separate arrangements for the interest amount. However, if the original tenure of an FCNR(B) deposit was three years or more and the remaining tenure at the time of availing the swap facility is less

Unified Payments Interface (UPI) Launches in Greece, Expands India's Global Digital Payments

IITM Bureau

Union Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said on Tuesday (June 30, 2026) that India's Unified Payments Interface (UPI) is now live in Greece, allowing eligible customers to transfer money quickly, securely and conveniently, with transaction costs significantly lower than traditional methods. Piyush Goyal wrote on the social media platform X that the global acceptance and appreciation of UPI is proof that the world trusts Prime Minister Narendra Modi's vision of technology-based solutions. He said these solutions are creating value beyond borders and

strengthening global partnerships for shared growth and prosperity. During his visit to Greece, Piyush Goyal met Eurobank CEO Phokion Karavias and discussed further strengthening the India-Greece economic partnership. Goyal said, "We encouraged Greek companies to invest in India and also discussed possibilities of cooperation in areas such as manufacturing and infrastructure development in Greece." The Union Minister also witnessed a live demonstration of the UPI service at the Eurobank headquarters in Athens, in partnership with Eurobank and NIPL (NPCI International Payments Limited). Eurobank CEO

Phokion Karavias and Fairfax Digital Services CEO Sanjay Tugnait were also present. The Minister stated that this is another significant milestone in the global expansion of India's digital payment systems. Earlier, Piyush Goyal, along with Greek Deputy Foreign Minister Harry Theoharis, addressed the India-Greece Business Forum. He also met with members of the Indian diaspora attending the event. In his address, Piyush Goyal noted that India's strong economic growth, stable macroeconomic situation, and continued economic progress offer significant investment and trade opportunities for Greece.

PM Modi welcomed Amazon's \$48 billion investment, saying it will create opportunities for the youth

IITM Bureau

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on June 25, welcomed Amazon's announcement of a \$48 billion investment in India, describing it as a significant step towards strengthening the country's digital economy and creating new employment opportunities for millions of young Indians. The Prime Minister said the investment reflects the growing confidence of global companies in India's economic potential and investment-friendly environment. Sharing his response on social media platform X, PM Modi referred to his meeting with Amazon CEO and President Andy Jassy and said, "It was



a wonderful meeting with Andy Jassy. I welcome Amazon's record \$48 billion investment in India. This will create new opportunities for our youth. It also reflects the growing interest worldwide in investing in India." The announcement came after Andy Jassy met the Prime Minister to discuss Amazon's long-term expansion plans in the country. In his post on X, Jassy said it was a productive meet-

ing where he outlined Amazon's vision for India's digital future. "It was a great meeting with Prime Minister Narendra Modi to discuss Amazon's future plans for India. We've been serving customers, sellers, developers, startups, and businesses in India for over a decade, and our journey is just beginning," Jassy wrote. He further revealed that Amazon will invest \$48 billion in India over the next five years, with more

than \$21 billion earmarked for expanding artificial intelligence (AI) and cloud infrastructure. The investment is expected to strengthen India's digital ecosystem while supporting innovation, technology adoption, and economic growth. Highlighting the expected impact of the investment, Jassy said Amazon aims to create 3.8 million jobs by 2030, enable \$80 billion in e-commerce exports, and extend the benefits of AI to 15 million small businesses and 4 million government school students across the country. The latest commitment will raise the company's planned investment in AI and cloud infrastructure in India.

than three years, banks will still be able to avail this facility. The RBI has also permitted banks to offer differential interest rates on FCNR(B) deposits. However, these rates will be determined based on the deposit period and amount. This will require adherence to the Reserve Bank's deposit interest rate guidelines. The central bank also clarified that banks can continue to offer normal FCNR(B) deposit schemes without using the swap facility. However, separate records of such deposits will need to be maintained.

The RBI has also clarified the rules related to external commercial borrowings (ECBs). According to the central bank, companies can raise ECBs for any period under the regulations. However, the special swap facility will only be available for ECBs with an average maturity period of at least three years. Furthermore, the swap period will be in line with the repayment period of the ECB, but its maximum limit will be five years. To make foreign currency deposits more attractive, the RBI has also exempted new FCN-

R(B) and NRE deposits from mandatory reserve requirements such as the Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR) and Statutory Liquidity Ratio (SLR). This will make it more profitable for banks to raise NRI deposits and offer better interest rates to customers. Overall, the RBI's clarifications are expected to facilitate smoother implementation of the FCNR(B) scheme, encourage higher foreign currency inflows, strengthen banks' ability to attract NRI deposits, enhance external sector resilience.

12 Years of Healthcare Reforms Transform India's Public Health System and Expand Access to Affordable Care

Ashmin Kaur

India's healthcare sector has undergone a sweeping transformation over the past 12 years, driven by large-scale investments in public health infrastructure, health insurance, digital healthcare, medical education and disease control programmes. The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW) said on June 8, 2026 that these reforms have strengthened healthcare delivery across the country and accelerated India's progress toward universal health coverage. From the rollout of the world's largest publicly funded health insurance programme to the establishment of more than 1.86 lakh

primary healthcare centres and the delivery of over 47 crore telemedicine consultations, the country's healthcare ecosystem has expanded significantly since 2014. The MoHFW's healthcare strategy has focused on making quality healthcare accessible and affordable for every citizen. According to findings from the National Statistical Office's 2025 survey covering over 1.39 lakh households, a growing number of Indians are relying on government healthcare facilities for treatment. The survey indicates that many patients seeking outpatient care at public hospitals and clinics incur little or no expenditure, while near-



ly half of hospitalised patients pay less than ₹1,100 for treatment. The trend suggests increasing public confidence in government healthcare institutions and reduced out-of-pocket healthcare spending, particularly among economically weaker households. The Ministry attributes this progress to sustained public investment in healthcare infrastructure, expan-

sion of insurance coverage, strengthening of disease-control programmes and the adoption of digital technologies across the healthcare system. Launched in 2018, Ayushman Bharat has emerged as the centrepiece of India's universal health coverage strategy. The programme rests on four pillars: the Ayushman Bharat-Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya

Yojana (AB-PMJAY), Ayushman Arogya Mandirs, the Pradhan Mantri Ayushman Bharat Health Infrastructure Mission (PM-ABHIM), and the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM). AB-PMJAY provides health insurance coverage of up to ₹5 lakh annually per family for economically vulnerable households. been provided through a network of 36,218 empanelled hospitals across the country. The programme was further expanded in October 2024 with the launch of Ayushman Bharat Vay Vandana , extending health insurance coverage to all senior citizens above the age of 70.

Centre Launches SUMAN Roadmap 2030 to Strengthen Maternal and Newborn Healthcare

IITM Bureau

Union Health Minister Jagat Prakash Nadda on Monday 29 June, 2026, launched the SUMAN Roadmap 2030, a strategic framework aimed at strengthening maternal and newborn healthcare and accelerating India's progress towards achieving the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) by 2030. The roadmap was unveiled during the 16th Conference of the Central Council of Health and Family Welfare (CCHFW) in the presence of Union Ministers of State for Health and Family Welfare Anupriya Patel and Prataprao Jadhav, Health Ministers from States and Union Territories, and senior officials of the

Ministry of Health and Family Welfare. Developed under the Reproductive, Maternal, Newborn, Child and Adolescent Health plus Nutrition (RM-NCHA+N) framework, the roadmap adopts a life-cycle approach covering pre-pregnancy, pregnancy, childbirth and the postnatal period. It integrates maternal and newborn care with child health, adolescent health, family planning and nutrition programmes to ensure continuity of care. The strategy places special emphasis on the identification and management of high-risk pregnancies through all stages of pregnancy and childbirth. It also addresses challenges

related to emergency obstetric care, referral transport, healthcare access in tribal and remote areas, community participation and the impact of climate change on maternal and newborn health. To accelerate progress in areas the roadmap proposes targeted interventions across 130 districts in 13 high-focus States. The roadmap includes a dedicated SUMAN Package for Pregnant Women, promoting early pregnancy registration, comprehensive antenatal care, institutional deliveries and postnatal follow-up. Other measures include bi-weekly home visits by ASHA workers during the final months of pregnancy.

PMSMA Turns 10: Centre Launches Nationwide Celebrations, Nadda to Unveil 'A Decade of Care' Campaign

IITM Bureau

The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW) will kick off nationwide celebrations on June 9, 2026, to commemorate a decade of the Pradhan Mantri Surakshit Matritva Abhiyan (PMSMA), one of India's flagship maternal healthcare initiatives aimed at ensuring safe pregnancies and healthy motherhood. The year-long observance, themed "10 Years of PMSMA - A Decade of Care," will be formally launched by Union Health and Family Welfare Minister Jagat Prakash Nadda at a national event in New Delhi. As part of the celebrations, awareness and outreach activities will be conducted across states and union ter-

ritories to encourage pregnant women and their families to avail themselves of the nine assured free antenatal care services offered under PMSMA. The campaign will also focus on spreading awareness about the importance of timely check-ups and quality antenatal care for reducing maternal and neonatal health risks. To mark the milestone, the Health Minister will release a special ₹75 commemorative coin and a ₹5 postal stamp, recognizing the programme's contribution to improving maternal healthcare and promoting safe motherhood across the country over the past decade. Launched on June 9, 2016, by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, PMSMA was



designed to provide free, comprehensive and quality antenatal care services to pregnant women on the 9th day of every month. The initiative has since emerged as a key component of India's maternal and child healthcare strategy. Over the last ten years, PMSMA has played a significant role in strengthening antenatal healthcare delivery by improving access to diagnostic services, counselling, risk assessment and specialist consultations

for expectant mothers. The programme has particularly focused on identifying and managing high-risk pregnancies, enabling timely medical interventions and reducing complications during childbirth. The MoHFW said PMSMA has become a vital pillar of the government's Reproductive, Maternal, Newborn, Child and Adolescent Health (RMNCH+A) strategy and supports the broader Continuum of Care approach.

ITIM Bureau

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Sunday June 28, 2026 said that India is making steady progress across various sectors, particularly in healthcare and social protection. He cited major milestones such as the World Health Organization (WHO) declaring the country Trachoma-free and the significant increase in the number of people covered under social security schemes. Addressing the 123rd episode of his monthly radio programme 'Mann ki Baat', PM Modi said that India is advancing in every sphere - from healthcare to social security - with a strong focus on inclusion and achieving saturation. He began by highlighting the nation's success in eliminating Trachoma.

ma, a bacterial eye infection that can lead to blindness, calling it a major public health achievement. "A lot of you must have heard about Trachoma. There was a time when it was common in many parts of India. If neglected, this disease could lead to blindness. But we resolved to eliminate it, and I am delighted to share with you that the World Health Organization has declared India Trachoma-free," PM Modi said. He credited the success to the relentless efforts of health workers and initiatives like Swachh Bharat Abhiyan and the Jal Jeevan Mission. "This success belongs to our health workers who fought this disease tirelessly. The Swachh Bharat Abhiyan played a major role in its elim-



ination. The Jal Jeevan Mission also contributed significantly. As clean water is reaching households through taps, the risk of such diseases has greatly reduced,” he noted. The Prime Minister added that the WHO appreciated India not only for eliminating the disease but also for addressing its root causes. Turning to social security, PM Modi cited a recent report by the International Labour Organization (ILO). “According to a recent ILO report, more than 64 per cent

of Indians are now covered under some kind of social protection. Social security coverage in India is among the largest in the world,” he said. “Today, around 95 crore people are benefiting from various social security schemes, whereas in 2015, the number was less than 25 crore. This reflects a significant shift towards social equity,” he said. The Prime Minister said such achievements are a testament to India’s commitment to inclusive growth.

Twelve Years of Healthcare Reforms Expand Affordable Care, Infrastructure and Digital Health Services Across India

IITM Bureau

India's healthcare sector has undergone a sweeping transformation over the past 12 years, driven by large-scale investments in public health infrastructure, health insurance, digital healthcare, medical education and disease control programmes. The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW) said on June 8, 2026 that these reforms have strengthened healthcare delivery across the country and accelerated India's progress toward universal health coverage. From the rollout of the

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number of Indians are relying on government healthcare facilities for treatment. The survey indicates that many patients seeking outpatient care at public hospitals and clinics incur little or no expenditure, while nearly half of hospitalised patients pay less than ₹1,100 for treatment. The trend suggests increasing public confidence in government healthcare institutions and reduced out-of-pocket healthcare spending, particularly among economically weaker households. The Ministry attributes this progress to



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The image shows the MedSeva logo, which consists of a green cross with a white bandage wrapped around it. Below the logo, the text "MedSeva" is written in a bold, sans-serif font, followed by the tagline "Because Health is Service." in a smaller font. To the right of the logo is a photograph of a building with a prominent dome and arched windows, likely a hospital or a community center.

health insurance coverage of up to ₹5 lakh annually per family for economically vulnerable households. Covering nearly 12 crore families, the scheme has evolved into the world's largest publicly funded health assurance programme. Since its launch, more than 44.14 crore Ayushman cards have been issued, while over 12.03 crore hospital admissions have been financed under the scheme. Treatment worth more than ₹1.80 lakh crore has been provided through a network of 36,218 empanelled hospitals across the country.

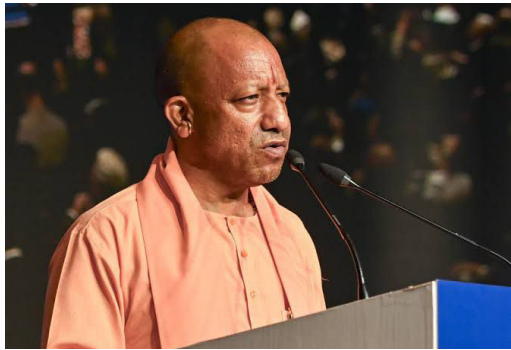
The programme was further expanded in October 2024 with the launch of Ayushman Bharat Vay Vandana, extending health insurance coverage to all senior citizens above the age of 70. By June 2026, over 1.20 crore senior citizens had enrolled under the initiative and availed treatment worth nearly ₹3,000 crore. The Ministry often cites stories such as that of Soni Kahtoon from Bihar, who underwent a life-saving heart valve replacement surgery free of cost under AB-PMJAY after her family had

exhausted its savings and incurred heavy debt while seeking treatment. Such cases, they said, illustrate the scheme's role in preventing medical emergencies from becoming financial catastrophes. A major component of the healthcare transformation has been the rapid expansion of primary healthcare facilities through Ayushman Arogya Mandirs. More than 1.86 lakh such centres are now operational across India, including sub-health centres, primary health centres, urban health centres and AYUSH facilities.

Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath Launches ‘Chalo School Campaign’ Phase 2, Stresses Attendance

IITM Bureau

Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath on 29 June, 2026 called on teachers and parents to work together to ensure regular school attendance as the state prepares to launch the second phase of the ‘Chalo School Campaign’ on July 1. In a post on X, the Chief Minister said July marks not only the beginning of a new month but also a renewed commitment to fulfilling the dreams of millions of children through education. “July is not merely the beginning of a new month, but also the time for renewing our resolve to bring the dreams of millions of children to school. In Uttar Pradesh, the second phase of the ‘Chalo School Campaign’ is commencing from July 1,” he said. Adityanath urged teachers to make classrooms more engaging so that children view school as an enjoyable learning environment rather than a daily obligation. He suggested incorporating activities such as sports and games to encourage greater student participation. “Dear teachers, ensure that children do not view school merely as part of a daily routine, but show genuine interest in attending. Activities such as sports and games can serve as excellent means to achieve this,” he said. The Chief Minister also appealed to parents to prioritise



their children’s regular attendance and assess them on the basis of their determination and dedication rather than academic performance alone. “Parents, evaluate your children not by their marks, but by their determination and dedication. It is you who must ensure their regular attendance at school,” he said. Describing the initiative as a people’s movement, Adityanath urged citizens to support the campaign to strengthen education across the state. “Transform the ‘Chalo School Campaign’ into a people’s movement. The future of Uttar Pradesh will shine brightly only when every child is nourished by education,” he added. The second phase of the ‘Chalo School Campaign’ will begin on July 1 with the objective of increasing school

enrolment and promoting regular attendance among children across Uttar Pradesh. The second phase of the School Chalo Abhiyan is being conducted across Uttar Pradesh from July 1 to July 15 with the goal of achieving near-universal school enrolment and bringing children who have dropped out back into the education system. The campaign focuses especially on identifying out-of-school children through door-to-door outreach by teachers, local officials, and community volunteers. During the launch, Yogi Adityanath distributed textbooks, school bags, and stationery to students.

‘School on Wheels’: Gujarat Converts 28 Buses Into Mobile Classrooms

IITM Bureau

On 23 June, 2026, Gujarat launched 28 solar-powered mobile classrooms created from retired state transport buses to provide uninterrupted education to children of Agariya families living in remote salt-producing regions of the state. The initiative, titled “School on Wheels” and locally known as Ranshala, aims to address educational disruptions caused by seasonal migration among Agariya communities in Surendranagar, Patan, Kutch and Morbi districts. The buses were flagged off from the Pathikashram State Transport Depot in Gandhinagar by Minister of State for Home Harsh Sanghavi, coinciding with the launch

NTA Conducts Nationwide Mock Drill Ahead Of NEET-UG 2026 Re-Exam

IITM Bureau

The National Testing Agency (NTA) on 20 June, 2026 conducted a nationwide mock drill as part of preparations for the NEET-UG 2026 re-examination scheduled for June 21. The exercise, which began at 9 a.m., will continue through the day. More than 2.5 lakh security personnel are participating in the drill being carried out across examination centres nationwide. Officials said all designated test centres have been brought under the NTA’s control. A three-layer security arrangement will be in place at every centre to prevent malpractice and ensure the integrity of the examination process. Under the security framework, paramilitary personnel will oversee the transportation, storage and protection of question papers and answer sheets. More than 5,000 examination centres across the country will remain under CCTV surveillance, supported by extensive deployment of security personnel. Meanwhile, the Delhi High Court on Friday upheld the Centre’s decision to temporarily restrict Telegram services ahead of the NEET-UG 2026 re-examination. The court observed that the government had followed due procedure while exercising its emergency blocking powers and that the restrictions were proportion-

ate to the situation. Rejecting a petition filed by Telegram FZ LLC against the blocking order issued by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), Justice Tejas Karia held that the temporary suspension of the messaging platform until June 22 and the disabling of its message-editing feature until June 30 were justified in view of concerns related to the examination. According to the Centre, Telegram had repeatedly been misused for examination-related fraud, with several channels allegedly involved in circulating fake NEET question papers and running related scams.

UPSC Direct Recruitment Applications Open Till July 17

IITM Bureau

The Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) has invited online applications from eligible candidates for direct recruitment to various Group ‘A’ and Group ‘B’ posts in different ministries and departments of the Government of India. According to a statement issued on Saturday, 27 June 2026, the recruitment drive is being conducted under Advertisement No. 07/2026, which has been published on the Commission’s official website along with detailed instructions for applicants. Interested candidates can submit their ap-



plications through the Online Recruitment Application (ORA) portal from June 27 to July 17, 2026. As per reports, the recruitment drive aims to fill 105 vacancies across multiple ministries and government departments. The UPSC has advised applicants to carefully read the eligibility criteria, educational qualifications, age limits, application

procedure and other important instructions mentioned in the detailed notification before filling out the online application form. Candidates should ensure that they meet all eligibility requirements as on the closing date, as incorrect or incomplete information may lead to rejection of the application. The Commission conducts direct recruitment to fill specialist, technical and administrative posts through a transparent selection process, which may include recruitment tests and interviews depending on the nature of the post. Details regarding vacancies, reservation, pay levels and selection procedures are available in the official advertisement. Eligible candidates can access the detailed advertisement and submit their applications online through the UPSC’s official website and the ORA portal before the July 17 deadline. The Commission has urged applicants not to wait until the last date to complete the registration process.

Vikram Misri encourages IIT Madras international graduates to drive innovation for Global South

IITM Bureau

Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri attended the degree distribution programme for international students at the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Madras and encouraged graduates to utilise their knowledge and expertise to address opportunities and challenges facing the Global South in an era of rapid technological change. IIT Madras organised its Degree Distribution Programme for international students on Friday (June 5 2026), celebrating the academic accomplishments of graduates from a range of programmes, including

MTech, MS, PhD, and various joint and international degree courses. The event brought together students from different countries who completed their studies at one of India’s premier technical institutions. Serving as the chief guest, Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri congratulated the graduating students and highlighted the importance of applying advanced skills and innovation to solve pressing global issues, particularly in developing nations. In a post on X on Saturday, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said, “Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri presided as Chief Guest at IIT

Madras’ degree distribution programme for international students on 05 June 2026. FS congratulated the graduating students and exhorted them to deploy the knowledge and skills acquired at IIT Madras to address the opportunities and challenges before humankind and the Global South in an era of technological transformation.” Through its premier institutions, India continues to strengthen academic cooperation and deepen diplomatic engagement with partner nations while contributing to global capacity building in science, technology and innovation. IIT Madras has been ac-



tively expanding opportunities for international students through its Office of Global Engagement (OGE), which offers multiple pathways for overseas applicants. These include scholarships and support mechanisms such as the IITM GE Scholarship, the Indian Council for Cultural Relations (ICCR) Scholarship, the Study in India programme, and initiatives supported by the African-Asian Rural Development Organisation (AARDO).



of the statewide Shala Praveshotsav school enrolment drive. Addressing the event, Sanghavi said the project demonstrated how unused Gujarat State Road Transport Corporation (GSRTC) buses could be repurposed for public welfare. “While Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel has launched the statewide Shala Praveshotsav from Vadnagar, Gujarat ST has presented an excellent example of how its unused buses can be put to the best possible use through

the Ranshala initiative in Agariya areas,” he said. He described the programme as an innovative model that delivers education directly to children living in remote desert settlements. “More than 20 children can study inside each bus, which is equipped with television and Dish TV facilities powered by solar energy. These children will also benefit from online classes conducted by the Gujarat Government,” Sanghavi said. He added that the initiative

would help ensure that children of salt-worker families no longer have to travel long distances to access education. “These buses, which were previously lying unused, have now been transformed into classrooms. More such buses will be prepared in the future so that not a single child living in remote areas is deprived of education,” he said. The project has been jointly implemented by Samagra Shiksha, the Education Department and GSRTC to support children aged between six and 14 years from families that migrate seasonally to salt-producing regions. Each mobile classroom is powered by a 3.8 KVA off-grid solar plant capable of operating for up to 48 hours without an external supply.

President Murmu Urges Tribal University Students to Blend Modern Education with Cultural Roots for Viksit Bharat

IITM Bureau

President Droupadi Murmu on 30 June said that the Central Tribal University of Andhra Pradesh has a special responsibility to emerge as a hub for fostering self-confidence, leadership and policy-making capabilities within tribal society, while calling on students to combine modern education with their cultural roots to contribute to the nation’s development. President Murmu said all universities, particularly tribal universities, should develop

innovative systems of skill development to enhance the livelihoods of tribal communities by promoting productive work in areas such as forest produce, handicrafts, millets, medicinal plants, eco-tourism and local entrepreneurship. Describing the convocation as a defining moment in every student’s life, the President said that it was not only a day of celebration but also an opportunity for graduates to make a commitment towards their future. President Droupadi Murmu urged students to focus on emerging areas

reach every section of society. She noted that, with this objective, the university has established a Science and Technology Hub to empower tribal communities in North Andhra Pradesh. Referring to the national goal of achieving Viksit Bharat by 2047, President Murmu expressed confidence that the Central Tribal University of Andhra Pradesh would make a significant contribution through its meaningful, teaching methodology, with a strong emphasis on environmental conservation.

President congratulate women's football team on SAFF Championship

IITM Bureau

President Droupadi Murmu and Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Sunday (June 7 2026) congratulated the Indian women's football team on winning the SAFF Women's Championship 2026 title, praising the players for their outstanding performances throughout the tournament. India reclaimed the SAFF Women's Championship crown after seven years with a commanding 3-1 victory over defending champions Bangladesh in the final at the Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium in Mar-



gao, Goa, on Saturday. “Heartiest congratulations to the Indian Women’s Football Team on winning the SAFF Women’s Championship 2026! Our women footballers displayed exceptional skill, determination and teamwork throughout the tournament. I am confident that their remarkable

achievement will inspire young girls across the nation to pursue their dreams with confidence and courage," the President posted on X. Prime Minister Narendra Modi also hailed the team's triumph, noting that they had played exceptionally well throughout the competition. He said the victory would encourage more youngsters to take up football in the years to come. "Congratulations to the Indian Women's Football Team on winning the SAFF Women's Championship 2026. They have played excellently through the tournament. This

will encourage more youngsters to play football in the coming times. Best wishes to the team for their future endeavours,” the Prime Minister posted on X. The title triumph marks another significant milestone for Indian women’s football and is expected to further boost the sport’s growing popularity across the country. The victory is expected to provide fresh momentum to women’s football in India, encouraging greater grassroots participation, strengthening the talent pipeline, and enhancing the country’s profile in international football.

Ireland Stun India with 2-0 T20 Series Win via a Thrilling One-Run Victory

IITM Bureau

Ireland became the makers of history by defeating India in a 2-0 on June 29 2026 with a clean sweep in the two-match T20 International series through a victory in the second and final match by a margin of just one run. It was a thrilling match that kept the cricket lovers on the edge of their seats right until the last ball. It is definitely one of the most historic wins by Ireland in international cricket. Ireland chose to bat first and scored a battling total due to some crucial performanc-



es by their top and middle-order batters. Though the Indian bowlers were successful in taking wickets regularly, Ireland continued to score runs in key partnerships to reach an impressive total. The batters showed nerves of steel by scoring some crucial runs for their side. India started their batting innings with confidence as they seemed to be in command in the initial stages. The opening batters gave India a good start, but Ireland bounced back with some crucial wickets in vital situations through their bowlers. The bowlers of Ireland maintained line and length throughout

their bowling spells. However, the climax of this exciting game came with the last few overs where Ireland defended the small target set by them with superb bowling and fielding. India did try their best with the bat, however, it could not get past the excellent bowling and fielding by Ireland, thereby conceding just one run to achieve a fantastic win. In this fashion, Ireland won 2-0 and celebrated with great delight while raising their trophy in front of their home fans. This was indeed a special day for Irish cricket as the

team displayed their true mettle in defeating one of the top sides of world cricket. The Indian side played with brilliant patches during the series; however, there were times when both batting and bowling performances could have been much better. However, it was an eye-opening experience for them who will definitely look to do much better in upcoming encounters. This series win will definitely go down as an iconic phase in the cricket history of Ireland as their hard work and efforts paid off.

World Cup Celebration Turns Tragic as One Person Dies in California Shooting

Aviraj Singh Chadha

A happy FIFA World Cup fan event in California on June 29 2026 became very sad after a shooting near the fan zone killed one person. Many football fans had come together to watch the World Cup match on a big screen. They were enjoying the game, but the happy atmosphere suddenly changed into fear and panic. According to the police, the shooting happened near the entrance of the fan zone. As soon as people heard the gunshots, they started running to stay safe. Some people hid behind tents and fences, while others quickly left the area. Police officers and ambulance teams arrived at the scene within a few minutes. One person was badly injured in the shooting and was taken to the hospital. Sadly, the

person died while receiving treatment. The police have not shared the victim's name because the family is still being informed. After the incident, the police closed the area with yellow crime scene tape. They started collecting evidence and speaking to people who saw what happened. Security around the fan zone was also increased to keep everyone safe. The police have not yet said why the shooting happened. They are trying to find the person responsible. They have also asked people to share any photos or videos that may help with the investigation. Before the shooting, the fan zone was full of people enjoying football, music, food, and spending time with family and friends. Fans from many countries had come together to celebrate the FIFA World Cup. The shooting shocked everyone and stopped the celebrations. Local officials said they were very sorry about the loss of life. They offered their condolences to the victim's family and promised to find those responsible. They also said they will work hard to keep fans safe during the rest of the World Cup. Officials have announced that security at World Cup fan zones will be made stronger. More police officers and security checks may be added to protect visitors during the remaining matches. This sad incident reminds everyone that safety is very important at public events. Football is a game that brings people together with happiness, but this tragedy has left many people shocked and heartbroken.

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England captain Ben Stokes Announces Retirement from International Cricket

IITM Bureau

England captain Ben Stokes has announced that he will retire from international cricket after the completion of the third Rothesay Test against New Zealand at Trent Bridge. With this it marks the end of one of the most remarkable careers in modern cricket. Since he made international debut in the year 2011 and in test in 2013 during the Ashes series, Stokes has established himself as one of England's greatest all-rounders and inspirational leaders. The ECB has confirmed that Ben Stokes will retire from international cricket after the Third Test against New Zealand. The Trent Bridge Test will be his last appearance in an England jersey and with this it concludes a distinguished international career which spanned nearly for 15 years.

His departure leaves a significant void in the England cricket, both as the match-winning all-rounder and as one of the team's most influential leaders. Stokes has also confirmed that he will step down as the England Men's Test captain, a role he has held since the April 2022. Ben Stokes began his international journey with the England's white-ball teams in the year 2011 before making his Test debut in December 2013 during the Ashes in Adelaide. Over the period of years, he evolved into one of the world's premier all-rounders, who is capable of changing the outcome of the matches with both bat and ball. Throughout his long career, Stokes has delivered the numerous unforgettable performances that are now part of the cricket history. One of the defining moments of

Mexico opens World Cup with passion, parties and protests

IITM Bureau

Mexico City opened the World Cup on Thursday (June 11 2026) at the famous Azteca stadium with a ceremony celebrating pre-Hispanic culture, as the ground rocked ahead of the tournament's first match between Mexico and South Africa that kicks off against a backdrop of protests around the capital. Fans in Mariachi costumes, with sombreros and trumpets, formed a sea of dark green support as Shakira and Burna Boy performed the 2026 World Cup anthem and pyrotechnics filled the ground. Alejandro Garcia, 50, decked out in a sombrero and carrying a replica trophy, said he was proud that Mexico was hosting another World Cup. He was a young kid when the country last hosted the tournament in 1986. "This is our temple," he said on the concourse around the Azteca. "It's going to be a great World Cup, all of the protests will now be forgotten." But outside the ground, the city of 9 million people remained deeply divided. The run-up to the tournament in Mexico, which the country is co-hosting with the U.S. and Canada, has



been marked by social unrest in the capital as various groups from teachers to families of those missing in the drug war have marched in attempts to leverage the international spotlight to advance their cause. At least six protests were planned on Thursday, with the city a contradiction of celebration and opposition. Freshly painted murals, new trains and a revamped stadium aimed at welcoming tourists for the games contrasted with steel barricades mounted by businesses to protect themselves from rioters along the capital's main avenue. About three miles from the Azteca, thousands of disgruntled teachers from around the country began marching towards the stadium ahead of the match. Avelina Cruz Miguel, who has taught elementary school for 22 years, travelled from Oaxaca to protest for better pay. She said the protests offered an opportunity for the

teachers to make their demands known at “an international level.” “There is no support for education” in Mexico, she said. Teachers had also camped outside the central Zocalo square for days leading up to the start of the tournament. The encampment forced authorities to barricade the entrance to the Zocalo on the eve of the competition opener and raised fears the area would be closed to fans who had planned to amass in the square to watch on a big screen. On Thursday, tents lined the streets for multiple blocks surrounding the square but authorities confirmed the fan zone would be open. Mario Martinez, 30, from Tijuana, was one of the first fans to enter with his girlfriend. He said they had come to the fan zone because stadium tickets were too expensive and had been worried the event would be cancelled. “Thank God it all worked out.”



his career came during the 2019 ICC Cricket World Cup Final against the New Zealand. Just few weeks after the World Cup triumph, Stokes had produced one of the greatest Test innings ever played. His unbeaten 135 at Headingley rescued England from near-certain defeat against the Australia during the Third Ashes Test and secured the extraordinary one-wicket victory. The innings is widely regarded as one of the finest chases in the Test cricket history. His unbeaten 84 runs guided the England to

a dramatic tie before the match was decided in the Super Over, and it helped the England to lift their first-ever Men's Cricket World Cup. His aggressive style, fearless attitude and ability to perform under the immense pressure helped him the earned him admiration across the cricketing world. In Cape Town in the year 2016, Stokes smashed a breathtaking 258 and he registered the highest Test score of his career while showcasing his aggressive batting style. Ben Stokes became the England's Test captain

in April 2022, started a new era of positive and attacking cricket. Under his leadership, England adopted the aggressive style that has transformed the team's approach towards Test cricket. After the announcement, senior officials from the England and Wales Cricket Board has paid tribute to Stokes remarkable contribution. ECB Chair Richard Thompson described the Ben Stokes as one of England's greatest-ever cricketers and one of the defining figures of his generation. He also praised the Stokes for producing extraordinary performances under pressure His partnership with the head coach Brendon McCullum has also encouraged the fearless batting, proactive captaincy, and entertaining cricket and revitalised England's performances in the longest format.